

James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Marketing and go-to-market operator with seven-plus years turning technical products into content that gets found, by people through search and social, and increasingly by AI answer engines. I write the analysis myself, build the pipelines that publish and measure it, and work in Claude Code daily. I am also a buyer of the tools Openbenchmarks tests: my own prospect engine runs Prospeo, Apollo, Clay, SalesQL and Hunter, and I compare those sources on real sends before I trust them. Work has contributed to \$10M+ in qualified pipeline and 15+ product launches. More at <https://jamespraise.xyz/work/openbenchmarks/>.

Selected Achievements:

- Built **AI-driven SEO and content systems at Reform** that increased non-branded organic traffic **48%**, scaled publishing velocity **30-100x** to about 100 articles a month, and built competitor comparison pages that produced **19% more decision-stage leads**.
 - Grew the **Marketing In Action newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate**, writing original, data-backed operator playbooks weekly.
 - Built a **prospect data and enrichment engine** of 40+ Python modules across 10+ sources, and ran a source comparison on real sends: database-verified emails came back **71% good and 2% bad**, against 53% good and 10% bad for website-scraped emails.
 - Ranked a seed-stage sales engagement platform, **Distrobird**, for **3,000+ keywords in 90 days**, with 500,000+ monthly impressions, in the crowded CRM and sales engagement category.
 - Published **31 marketing agent skills** for Claude Code on GitHub, including the AI search and SEO audit skills I run on live sites.
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KEY SKILLS

Content & Distribution: Data-Led Content, Technical Writing for Developer and Operator Audiences, LinkedIn/X/Hacker News Distribution, Newsletter Growth, Comparison and Alternatives Content.

Search & AI Visibility: Technical and On-Page SEO, Answer Engine Optimization (AEO), Intent Page Architecture, Search Console and GA4 APIs, Structured Data, [llms.txt](#).

Data & Build: Claude Code, Python, SQL, Data Visualization (SVG and chart generation from raw data), API Enrichment Pipelines, n8n, headless Chrome tooling.

GTM: Positioning & Messaging, Launch Strategy, Competitive Intelligence, Product-Led Growth, Account-Based Marketing.

Tools: Clay, Apollo, Prospeo, Hunter, SalesQL, MillionVerifier, Ahrefs, DataForSEO, HubSpot, Webflow, GitHub.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (Newsletter, Media, Academy, Community)

- Built an execution-first marketing media business from zero and grew the newsletter to **5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate**.
- Published **31 marketing agent skills** on GitHub (github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills), including AI search, SEO audit and competitive intelligence skills.
- Built a **prospect data and enrichment engine** (40+ standard-library Python modules, 10+ sources, self-built MX and SMTP verifier) and ran it at production scale: 409 companies sourced to 267 send-ready leads in one run.
- Built an **AI search and measurement system** for a content site: Search Console, URL Inspection and GA4 Data APIs pulled into a scheduled snapshot tracker, which found a sitemap discovery failure dashboards had missed.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026

Reform (SaaS, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy 2023)

- Built two iterations of an **AI SEO content pipeline** (DataForSEO keyword and SERP data, a self-authored brief framework, prompt chains). **48% lift in non-branded organic traffic, 22% lift in domain rating, publishing velocity up 30-100x**.
- Built **competitor comparison pages** and supporting objection handling. **19% more decision-stage leads**.
- Repositioned the product into a conversion-focused category. **34% lift in trial activation**.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026

FunnelEnvy (B2B, Revenue Funnel Optimization Service Provider)

- Built content and enablement infrastructure producing 10+ multi-channel outputs per asset. **40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads**.
- Built an account-based marketing playbook. **31% lift in enterprise meeting bookings, 27% increase in outbound reply rates**.

Head of Inbound Growth Marketing | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024

Distrobird (Seed-stage SaaS, Sales Engagement Platform, North America)

- Owned inbound across SEO, content, community and events in the saturated CRM and sales engagement category. **3,000+ keywords ranked in 90 days, 500,000+ monthly impressions, 5,000+ organic clicks.**

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti (YC W23) | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024

Bujeti (FinTech SaaS, Spend & Expense Management)

- First marketing hire. Built acquisition, product marketing and lifecycle from zero. **1,331 MQLs in 6 months, 500% increase in new B2B customers in Q1 2024.**

Chief Revenue Officer (from Sales Manager) | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023

CIL (B2B, Technology Solutions & Technical Training Provider)

- Ran go-to-market across five African markets. **1,646 MQLs, 406 SQLs, 629 demos booked, \$3.4M open deal value.**

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022

B2B, SaaS, FinTech, ecommerce, agencies

SELECTED PUBLIC WORK

- **Openbenchmarks company enrichment write-up and search-position audit** — jamespraise.xyz/work/openbenchmarks/proof/
 - **Marketing Agent Skills** — 31 Claude Code skills published publicly. github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills
 - **Marketing In Action newsletter** — newsletter.marketinginaction.xyz
 - **Case studies** — Reform, Distrobird, Bujeti, CIL, FunnelEnvy and others. jamespraise.xyz/work
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EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026), CGPA 4.92/5.0
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018), CGPA 4.46/5.0
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- 70+ certifications across growth, analytics, product, AI, sales and marketing operations